Jinxin Wu

Department of Economics, Georgetown University

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EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Economics 2021 - 2027 (expected)
Georgetown University, Department of Economics Washington, DC

M.A. in International Economics and International Relations 2015 – 2017
Johns Hopkins University, School of Advanced International Studies Washington, DC

B.A. in Journalism 2006 – 2010
Fudan University Shanghai, China

RESEARCH FIELDS

Primary: Macroeconomics, Public Finance

Secondary: Quantitative Macroeconomics, Fiscal Policy, Taxation

WORKING PAPERS

Optimal Defense Spending and Taxation in a Dynamic Economy *Job Market Paper*

This paper asks how governments should protect productive capital from destructive threats and finance that protection. I develop a dynamic general-equilibrium model in which geopolitical risk determines destruction risk, defense mitigates capital losses but diverts resources from investment, and protection is financed through labor and capital income taxes. A distinctive feature of this model is that capital is simultaneously a productive asset, the object of protection, and a tax base that can finance its own protection. Defense and investment are dynamically complementary: greater protection encourages investment, while more capital increases the value of protection. This complementarity generates endogenous adaptation, so greater risk need not reduce long-run capital and output. A government that can commit to future policies relies primarily on labor taxation and may subsidize post-shock rebuilding. Without commitment, it taxes installed capital, reducing both investment and protection. The inability to commit therefore harms the productive base by both discouraging capital accumulation and weakening its protection. In the benchmark calibration, it generates a welfare loss of 2.25 percent, 15 percent of which arises from weaker protection. A defense-spending mandate can further reduce welfare, whereas restricting capital taxation recovers 84 percent of the welfare gain from commitment.

Propagation of Macroeconomic Shocks Through Input-Output and Geographic Networks in China (with Ergys Islamaj)

We study how sector-specific shocks propagate through production and regional networks. Using international, national, and inter-regional input-output tables, we distinguish direct industry exposure from indirect upstream, downstream, and geographic exposure. China has the largest aggregate network exposure among the economies examined, equivalent to near 50 percent of its economic activity, with manufacturing accounting for a particularly large share. In an application to Chinese export demand, the estimates show positive own-industry and upstream patterns but no clear downstream response. The results provide evidence consistent with propagation from directly exposed industries to their domestic suppliers.

WORK IN PROGRESS

Temporary Spending or Lasting Growth? Government Procurement and Human Capital

This project asks why some government contracts build lasting local productive capacity while others generate mainly temporary demand. Using contract-level U.S. defense procurement data, I classify contracts by skill intensity and link county-level procurement exposure to labor-market and innovation outcomes. Preliminary

results suggest that skill-intensive contracts generate more persistent employment and income gains. I will test whether human-capital accumulation and cross-industry spillovers explain this persistence. I am developing a dynamic local-economy model in which skill-intensive procurement builds human capital through learning and worker upgrading, allowing temporary spending increases to have persistent local effects.

Legal rules, Financial Structure, and Firm Investment (w. Joshua Teitelbaum)

Effects of Elite Colleges Expanding Free Tuition in the U.S. (with Mihyun You)

RESEARCH AND PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Georgetown University 2022–2024
Research Assistant to Prof. Toshihiko Mukoyama Washington, DC

- Constructed a firm-establishment-level panel dataset from multiple large-scale administrative datasets.

Research Assistant to Prof. Xiang Ding

- Assisted in compiling a global dataset on inter-sectoral capital service expenditures, enabling the construction of the first global input-output matrix of capital services.

The World Bank Group 2017–2021
Research Analyst, Prospects Group Washington, DC
Won VPU Team Award, 2021 and 2022

- Helped develop and maintained forecasting models and provided analysis in flagship report *Global Economic Prospects* and *Commodity Markets Outlook*.
- Co-authored policy reports on commodity markets, production networks, and informal economy.

The Financial Times 2010–2014
Researcher, FT Confidential Research Shanghai, China

- Researched and wrote on China's economic reforms, financial regulations, and capital market.

POLICY PUBLICATIONS

- "Propagation of Macroeconomic Shocks Through Input-Output and Geographic Networks in China," in *East Asia and Pacific Economic Update, April 2019: Managing Headwind*, World Bank, 34-36, with Ergys Islamaj and Francesca de Nicola.
- "Informal Economy in East Asia and Pacific," in *Global Economic Prospects, January 2019: Darkening Skies*, World Bank, 63-67, with Ekaterine T. Vashakmadze.
- "Spillovers to Developing East Asia and Pacific from China," in *East Asia and Pacific Economic Update*, World Bank, October 2018, 39-42, with Ergys Islamaj and Ekaterine T. Vashakmadze.
- "Raw material commodity prices gain momentum amid stronger demand," World Bank, Dec 2020.
- "Beverage commodity prices to stabilize amid stronger demand and ample supplies," World Bank, December 2020.
- "Global food commodity prices in a post-COVID world," World Bank, November 2020.
- "Food prices to edge up in 2019 but energy, trade, and foreign exchange could unsettle outlook," World Bank, November 2020.
- "Beverage prices weak on good crops and currency movements," World Bank.
- "Raw materials outlook: Cotton, rubber prices to stabilize in 2019," World Bank.
- "Food prices: Markets are well-supplied, but trade tensions, energy prices, and an Africa Swine Fever outbreak could create market instability," World Bank.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Georgetown University

Instructor

Intermediate Macroeconomics — 2024 Summer (5/5, evaluation)

Intermediate Macroeconomics — 2025 Summer (4/5, evaluation)

Graduate Teaching Assistant — 2022–2026

International Finance; Money, Banking and Financial Markets; Intermediate Macroeconomics; Introduction to Econometrics; International Trade; Economic Analysis of Law;

AWARDS

Sixth Year Merit-Based Fellowship, Georgetown University — 2026
Graduate School Fellowship, Georgetown University — 2021–2026
Department of Economics Summer Research Fellowship, Georgetown University — Summer 2024
National Merit Scholarship, Fudan University — 2009
Tsang Hin Chi Scholarship, Fudan University — 2009
Freshman Merit Scholarship, Fudan University — 2006

PRESENTATIONS AND WORKSHOPS

National Tax Association 119th Annual Conference — 2026*
Macroeconomics Seminar at Georgetown University — 2026
5th Annual Macro Meetings at Georgetown (AMMEEGO) Conference — 2025
Macroeconomics workshops at Georgetown University — 2023–2026

SERVICE AND SKILLS

Co-chair, Economics Graduate Student Organization — 2024–2025

Computation: MATLAB, Python, R, Stata, EViews

Languages: Chinese (native), English (professional fluency)

REFERENCES

Toshihiko Mukoyama, co-advisor
Professor, Department of Economics
Georgetown University
tm1309@georgetown.edu

Axel Anderson, co-advisor
Professor, Department of Economics
Georgetown University
aza@georgetown.edu

Joshua Teitelbaum
David Belding Professor of Law, Law Center
Professor of Economics, Department of Economics
Georgetown University
jct48@law.georgetown.edu